PARMAR RAILWAY

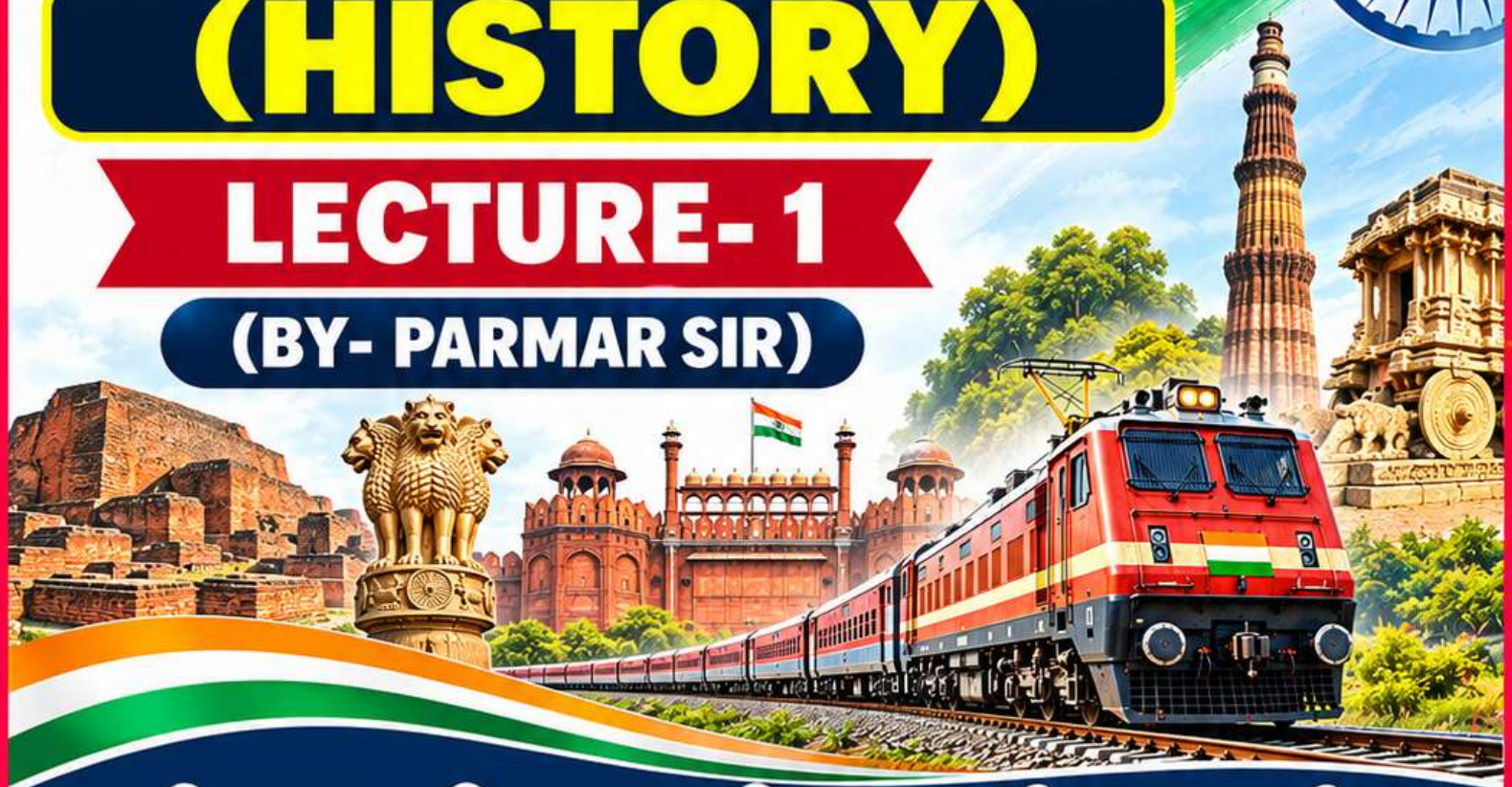
COMPLETE GK PYQ BATCH

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

(HISTORY)

LECTURE- 1

(BY- PARMAR SIR)



ANCIENT INDIA | MEDIEVAL INDIA | MODERN INDIA | FREEDOM STRUGGLE | POST INDEPENDENCE

Q.1 The Harappan Civilization flourished mainly during which of the following archaeological eras?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (17 Jun, 2026 (12:45 PM - 2:15 PM))]

A. Neolithic Age
B. Bronze Age
C. Iron Age
D. Chalcolithic Age

- **Harappan Civilisation = Bronze Age** civilisation
  - Bronze = alloy of copper + tin
  - Copper + zinc = brass (not bronze)
- Time period of the civilisation: about **2500 - 1750 BC**
- BC = years counted back from the birth of Christ
  - Example: **500 BC = 500 years** before Christ's birth (from **2026, 500 BC is 2026 + 500 = 2526 years** ago)

- Phases of the civilisation (it grew slowly, matured, then declined - like childhood, youth, old age)
  - Early Harappan: from **3000 BC** (till about **2600 BC**)
  - Mature Harappan: about **2600/2500 - 1900 BC**
  - Late Harappan: **1900 - 1700 BC**
- **Three-age classification (done by C.J. Thomsen)**
  - **Stone Age = Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic**
  - **Bronze Age** = Harappan / **Indus Valley Civilisation**
  - **Iron Age = Vedic Age** (specifically the Later **Vedic Age**)
- Neolithic = **New Stone Age**

Q.2 Which of the following is cited as evidence for a highly centralised administration in the Indus-Sarasvati civilisation?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (22 Aug, 2025 Shift 2)]

A. Elaborate royal tombs
B. Absence of seals and standard script
C. Standardised weights and measures
D. Monumental palaces and temples

- All weights and measures were standardised -> shows a highly centralised administration
- Weights were used in **multiples of 16**
- Bricks were also used in a standard ratio of **1:2:4**

Q.3 With reference to Harappan architecture, which statement is/are correct?
I. Streets were straight and cut at right angles.
II. Street drains were covered by stone slabs.

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (25 Mar, 2026 Shift 2)]

A. Only II
B. Both I and II
C. Neither I nor II
D. Only I

- Magnificent town planning; the civilisation was urban
- **Grid pattern**: streets were straight and cut each other at 90 degrees
- Street drains were covered with stone slabs (mainly limestone)
- Every house had its own private well

- Limestone is an example of a sedimentary rock
- Burnt bricks in a standardised ratio of **1:2:4** were used in town planning (urban planning)
- All cities/sites were divided into two parts: **Upper Town and Lower Town**

Q.4 Which of the following is a distinctive feature found in Harappan cities?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (24 Mar, 2026 Shift 1)]

A. Religious processions
B. Trade routes
C. Efficient transportation
D. Drainage system

- Very well planned drainage system
- Drain of every house joined a common drain
- Drains and potholes (manholes) were covered with stone

- **Sumps and cesspits were built along the drains**
  - Used to collect solid waste
  - Work like an iron mesh in a drain: large waste gets stuck and can be removed

Q.5 What was the main purpose of the citadel in Harappan cities?

[RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (19 Jun, 2025 Shift 1)]

A. To function as a marketplace
B. To function as a residential area
C. To organise administrative and public functions
D. To organise religious ceremonies

- **Harappan cities were divided into two parts**
  - **Upper Town** (also called **Higher Town**) = **Citadel** (also called **Acropolis**), on the western side
  - **Lower Town** – no special name
- Citadel was used for administrative and public functions
- Citadel and lower town were both fortified (walled)

- City without a citadel: Chanhudaro (memory tip: C for **Citadel**, C for **Chanhudaro**)
- City divided into three parts: Dholavira (**Gujarat**); also famous for its giant water reservoirs
- The **Great Bath** was part of the citadel





Q.6 Which of the following is NOT a true element of Harappan architecture?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (07 May, 2026 (4:30 PM - 6:00 PM))]

A. Cities included public buildings and well-planned houses
B. Buildings in Harappan cities were made of standardized baked bricks
C. Architecture focused on functional design rather than decoration
D. Cities had magnificent palaces, monuments and royal tombs

- No palaces, monuments or royal tombs were found
- **True elements**
  - Well-planned houses, public buildings and proper drainage
  - Baked (burnt) bricks of standard size - not raw bricks
  - Focus on functional design, not decoration

- **Harappan script**
  - Mainly pictographic (pictures used as writing)
  - Writing style: boustrophedon - one line right to left, next line left to right, and so on
  - Script is undeciphered - nobody knows yet what it says or how it was written (the **Tamil Nadu** government under **M.K. Stalin** announced a **$1 million / ~₹9 crore prize** for anyone who deciphers it)
  - A period with a script that cannot be read is called **Proto-history** (proto-historic period)

Q.7 Which of the following is a significant component of the Harappan citadel?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (17 Mar, 2026 Shift 1)]

A. Huge temples
B. Grand palaces
C. Dwelling houses
D. The Great Bath

- **Great Bath (Vishal Snanagar)** and **Great Granary (Vishal Annagar)** were found at **Mohenjo-daro**, not at **Harappa** (at **Harappa**, six granaries in each row were found)
- **Great Bath**
  - Waterproofed using gypsum and mortar
  - Size: 12 m long, 7 m wide, about 2.5 m or 2.4 m deep
- **Great Granary**
  - Largest building of the site
  - Used to store grains

- **Harappa**
  - Discovered in **1921** by **Daya Ram Sahni**
  - On the banks of the **Ravi**
  - First site of the civilisation to be discovered -> civilisation is also called Harappan
- **Mohenjo-daro**
  - Discovered in **1922** by **R.D. Banerjee (Rakhal Das Banerjee)**
  - On the banks of the Indus
  - One of the largest sites (not the largest)
  - Also called **Mound** of the **Dead**

Q.8 In which district of Gujarat is the Harappan archaeological site of Dholavira, recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site, situated?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (27 Mar, 2026 Shift 2)]

A. Jamnagar District
B. Banaskantha District
C. Kutch District
D. Patan District

- Dholavira is in **Kutch** district, **Gujarat**; a **UNESCO World Heritage Site**
- City divided into three parts
- Known for its giant water reservoirs
- **J.P. Joshi** discovered it; **R.S. Bisht** excavated it

Q.9 Which of the following features at Lothal provides the most convincing evidence of its role as a maritime trading centre in Harappan Civilization?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (08 May, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

A. A large warehouse located near the dock structure
B. Discovery of seals indicating contacts with distant regions
C. A brick-built basin connected to an ancient river channel
D. Evidence of bead-making workshops within settlement

- Lothal (**Gujarat**) = ancient port / dockyard
- Maritime trade centre means it lay on the coast and ships came there
- Seals only show trade contacts (seals were stamped on goods/packages and broken on arrival, and have been found at many sites), not sea trade
- The brick-built basin (dock) joined to an ancient river channel is the strongest proof of maritime trade

- Lothal was discovered by **S.R. Rao**
- Burial system at **Lothal**: double / dual burial (also called Laila-Majnu burial) - husband and wife buried together
- Chanhudaro is completely lacking a fortified citadel
- **Bead-making sites**
  - Chanhudaro (**Pakistan**; site without a citadel)
  - Balakot (**Pakistan**; also the place where India conducted air strikes)
  - Nageshwar (**Gujarat**)

Q.10 Which Harappan site shows evidence of ploughed fields?

[RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (11 Jun, 2025 Shift 1)]

A. Dholavira
B. Kalibangan
C. Lothal
D. Mohenjo-daro

- Kalibangan gave evidence of ploughed fields
- Located in **Rajasthan**, on the banks of the **Ghaggar** river

- Fire altars were found at **Kalibangan** (also at **Lothal**)
- Kalibangan = "black bangles" → black bangles were found here

Q.11 Who initiated a major archaeological or scientific study related to the Harappan site of Rakhigarhi in 2013?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (18 Mar, 2026 Shift 1)]

A. B.B. Lal
B. R.S. Bisht
C. Vasant Shinde
D. Amrendra Nath

- Rakhigarhi is in Haryana, on the banks of the **Ghaggar**
- Now the largest Harappan site in **India** (earlier **Mohenjo-daro** was considered the largest, but newly discovered area at **Rakhigarhi** made it bigger)
- **R.S. Bisht** (along with **J.P. Joshi**) is linked with **Dholavira**, not **Rakhigarhi**

- Finds at **Rakhigarhi**: terracotta wheel and terracotta toys
- Terracotta = baked (burnt) clay

Q.12 Which Late Harappan and Chalcolithic site in Maharashtra has yielded excellent examples of metalcast sculptures?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 (08 May, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

A. Chandoli (Chandoli)
B. Tekwada (Tekwada)
C. Inamgaon (Inamgaon)
D. Daimabad (Daimabad)

- Daimabad = Late Harappan + **Chalcolithic** site in **Maharashtra**
- It is the largest **Chalcolithic** site of **Maharashtra**
- Famous for metal-cast (bronze) sculptures

- Chalcolithic = "**Copper-Stone Age**"
  - Copper was the first metal discovered by humans
  - Time: roughly **2000 - 1000 BC**
  - It ran parallel to / overlapped with the **Indus Valley Civilisation** (especially the Late Harappan phase)
- Bronze = copper + tin; tin was brought from **Afghanistan**, and copper was sourced from **MP, Maharashtra**, and **Rajasthan** regions
- Tekwada (option B) is an **Iron Age** site in **Maharashtra**

Q.13 What was the dominant type of economy in the Harappan heartland?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (22 Mar, 2026 Shift 3)]

A. Spiritual-centric
B. Hunting-gathering
C. Trade-based economy
D. Agro-pastoral

- Harappans carried on extensive trade; proof of long-distance trade exists
  - Harappan seals have been found in **Iraq, Oman and Bahrain**

- **Other options ruled out**
  - Spiritual-centric: no temples or similar remains found
  - Hunting-gathering: way of life of **Palaeolithic (Old Stone Age)** people
  - Agro-pastoral: mainly the Vedic people

Q.14 The Harappans were first in Eurasia to grow ____.

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (12 Aug, 2025 Shift 2)]

A. Indigo
B. Mustard Seeds
C. Potato
D. Cotton

Meluhha (also spelled Meluha) primarily refers to the ancient Bronze Age trading partner of Mesopotamia

- Harappans were the first in **Eurasia** to grow cotton
- Cotton was called **Sindon**; the name **Sindhu** (Indus) civilisation is linked to it

Q.15 The Harappan civilisation primarily sourced its copper from which region?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (17 Mar, 2026 Shift 2)]

A. Karnataka
B. Madhya Pradesh
C. Rajasthan
D. Tamil Nadu

- Karnataka was known as **Swarnagiri** -> source of gold (**Kolar Gold Fields**), not copper

- Rajasthan was the nearest copper source to the Harappan region -> primary source (though **MP** and **Maharashtra** also had **Chalcolithic** copper sites, **Rajasthan** was closest)
- Chalcolithic cultures of **Rajasthan**: Ahar (**Banas**) and Gilund cultures

Q.16 Harappan trade relations extended to:

[RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (19 Jun, 2025 Shift 2)]

A. Mesopotamia
B. Greece
C. Persia
D. Rome

- **Trading ports on the way between Harappa and Mesopotamia**
  - Dilmun = today's **Bahrain**
  - Magan = today's **Oman**
- Catalhuyuk = an ancient proto-city in **Turkey**

- Mesopotamia = ancient civilisation of Iraq; called the **Cradle of Civilisation**
- Mesopotamians called the **Harappans Meluhha**
- Traded in many items, including precious stones
- Mesopotamia lay on the banks of the **Euphrates** (or **Tigris**)
- Trade was by ships - ships are shown on Harappan seals

Q.17 Which material was mainly used for making beads and seals in Harappan civilization?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 (25 Mar, 2026 Shift 3)]

A. Terracotta
B. Gold
C. Steatite
D. Ivory

- Steatite = a very soft stone (also called soapstone)
- Seals (and beads) were made from steatite

Q.18 Which animal/bird was commonly depicted on Harappan seals?

[RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 (12 Jun, 2025 Shift 3)]

A. Horse
B. Peacock
C. Unicorn
D. Sparrow

- Unicorn = a one-horned animal; considered mythological, not found today (also shown in **Hrithik Roshan's** dreams in the ***Mohenjo Daro*** movie)
- Most common animal on Harappan seals

- Seals show animal figures
- **Proto-Shiva seal (also called Pashupati seal)**
  - Made of steatite
  - Shows the figure in a yogic posture, believed to be an early form of **Shiva**
  - Animals shown - memory tip "**BETR Deer**": Buffalo (teacher said **Bull**), **Elephant**, **Tiger**, **Rhino**, **Deer**
- **Evidence of horse**: found at **Surkotada** - only a single horse bone
  - One bone cannot prove that **Harappans** knew horses (not even a full skeleton was found)

Q.19 Which of the following is INCORRECT about the Harappans?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (08 Aug, 2025 Shift 2)]

A. The most favoured ornaments were beads of carnelian.
B. They exported ornaments, timber, daily use objects.
C. The Harappans were engaged in active trade.
D. The Harappans used only gold to make tools, pots and pans.

- "Only" is an extreme keyword (only, all, none, never) -> such options are usually wrong
- Harappans also used copper, tin and bronze; that is why the civilisation is called **Bronze Age**
- Options A, B and C are correct

- **Stones used by Harappans**
  - Carnelian - orange stone; obtained from **Gujarat**
  - Lapis lazuli - blue stone; from **Shortughai (Afghanistan)** and the **Badakhshan** mines
  - Jadeite - green stone; from the **North-East (Brahmaputra** valley)

Q.20 Which of the following is a well-known bronze artefact from the Indus Valley Civilisation, dating to around 2500 BCE?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (21 Aug, 2025 Shift 2)]

A. Stone seal of unicorn from Lothal
B. Priest-King statue from Mohenjo-daro
C. Painted pottery vase from Dholavira
D. Dancing Girl statue from Mohenjo-daro

- **Dancing Girl** statue is kept in the **National Museum, Delhi**

- **Dancing Girl** - found at **Mohenjo-daro**; made of bronze
  - Made by the lost-wax technique
  - Height: **10.5 cm**
  - Shown in **Tribhanga** posture
  - Stone seal and **Priest-King** are made of steatite (stone), not bronze

Q.21 The Priest-King statue from Mohenjo-daro, a famous stone sculpture, is predominantly made of which of the following substances?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (03 Sept, 2025 Shift 3)]

A. Terracotta
B. Steatite
C. Bronze
D. Limestone

- The **Bearded Man** is kept in the **National Museum of Pakistan**

- Priest-King statue (also called the **Bearded Man**) - from **Mohenjo-daro**; made of steatite (soft stone)
- Height: **17.5 cm** (about 7 inches)

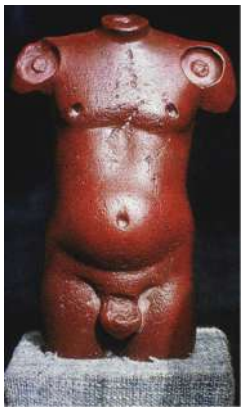
Q.22 The famous male torso from Harappa, remarkable for its naturalistic pose and chiselled in the round, is made of _____.

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (29 Aug, 2025 Shift 2)]

A. steatite
B. red limestone
C. bronze
D. terracotta

- Male torso was found at **Harappa**; made of red limestone
- Elimination: terracotta is baked clay; bronze is a metal (the torso does not look metallic); steatite is a very soft stone

- **Granaries at Harappa: six granaries in each row**
  - In front of them, circular brick platforms were found, where grain was discovered (confirming they were granaries)
- The **Great Granary and Great Bath** were at **Mohenjo-daro**, not at **Harappa**



Q.23 Which of the following substances constitutes the primary material of the "Mother Goddess" sculpture originating from Indus Valley Civilisation?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (01 Sept, 2025 Shift 3)]

A. Bronze
B. Limestone
C. Terracotta
D. Steatite

- **Mother Goddess** figurine - from **Harappa**; made of terracotta (baked clay)
- A plant growing from the womb (embryo) is shown -> she is an **Earth Goddess** (the earth gives birth to crops)
- Bronze is the material of the **Dancing Girl**, not of the **Mother Goddess**

- **Quick summary of finds at Mohenjo-daro vs Harappa:**
  - Mohenjo-daro: Proto-Shiva seal (steatite), **Priest-King / Bearded Man** (steatite; in **Pakistan's National Museum**), **Dancing Girl** (bronze; in **India's National Museum, Delhi**), **Great Bath**, and **Great Granary** (single large granary)
  - Harappa: **Mother Goddess / Goddess Earth** (terracotta), **Male** torso (red limestone), and six granaries in each row

Q.24 During the Indus Valley Civilisation, the presence of jewellery made from precious metals in small-town settings supports the argument that _____.

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 (29 Aug, 2025 Shift 1)]

A. the civilisation was ruled by autocratic priest-kings
B. there was an equal access to material goods
C. there was strong social stratification
D. only the elite had access to luxury items.

- Jewellery of precious metals even in small towns shows strong social stratification
- Society was divided into layers - some rich, some poor

- Burial at **Harappa**: coffin burial - dead were buried in a wooden coffin (whereas **Lothal** had double burial)



Q.25 According to references in the Rigveda, the early Vedic Aryans inhabited a region known as:

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 20 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

1. **Sapta-Sindhu**
2. Aryavarta
3. Madhyadesha
4. Brahmavarta

- **Evidence of this common origin**
  - Language: many similar words in English and Hindi, e.g. andar - under, bhrata - brother
  - Boghazkoi inscription (in Turkey): has names like **Indra and Varuna**

- **Early Vedic Aryans occupied Sapta-Sindhu**
  - The region of the Indus and its five tributaries: Jhelum, **Chenab, Ravi, Beas, Sutlej**
- **Vedic Aryans are believed to have come from Central Asia**
  - One part of the tribe moved to **Europe**, another part came to **India**

Q.26 Which innovation correctly illustrates Mesolithic advances in subsistence and technology in India?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 18 Jun, 2026 (4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)]

1. Emergence of polished stone axes associated with settled agricultural villages
2. **Use of microlithic tools along with bow-and-arrow and plant-processing implements**
3. Manufacture of heavy flake tools similar to Lower Paleolithic hand-axes
4. Adoption of iron tools indicates an early transition to metal-using cultures

- Mesolithic = **Middle Stone Age**; famous for microlithic tools (micro = small, lithic = stone)
- **Other options belong to other ages**
  - Polished stone tools and settled farming -> **Neolithic**
  - Heavy hand-axes -> **Lower Palaeolithic**
  - Iron tools -> Later Vedic (**Iron Age**); neither **Harappans** nor Early Vedic people knew iron

- **Stone Age has three parts**: Palaeolithic **(Old), Mesolithic (Middle), Neolithic (New)**
  - Palaeolithic is the oldest; **Neolithic** is the newest
- Palaeolithic people used thick, heavy stones; **Mesolithic** people used tiny stones

Q.27 Which among the following best represents the change in society from the Early to the Later Vedic period?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 19 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

1. Decline of agriculture and rise in hunting
2. **Emergence of a complex varna hierarchy**
3. End of religious practices and rituals
4. Shift from settled villages to nomadic life

- **Vedic Age: 1500 - 500 BC**, divided into two parts
  - Early Vedic **(Rig Vedic) Age: 1500 - 1000 BC**
  - Later **Vedic Age: 1000 - 500 BC**
- Early **Vedic Age** is also called **Rig Vedic Age** because the **Rig Veda** was compiled in it
- **Varna system**
  - Early Vedic: based on profession (what work you did decided your varna)
  - Later Vedic: became hereditary and rigid (son of a **Kshatriya = Kshatriya, Brahmin's** son = **Brahmin, Vaishya's** son = **Vaishya, Shudra's** son = **Shudra**)
- Other options are wrong: hunting belongs to the **Stone Age**; religious rituals actually increased;

- **Early Vedic vs Later Vedic**
  - Economy: pastoral community (grazing cows and buffaloes) -> agriculture (iron was discovered in the Later **Vedic Age**)
  - Women: better condition -> condition deteriorated
  - Varna: flexible, profession-based -> hereditary, rigid
  - Religion: no idol worship -> idol worship started (as taught by the teacher)
  - Rituals and sacrifices became many and had to be done by **Brahmins**; **Brahmins** had to be given gifts (dana)
- **Result: Jainism and Buddhism arose**
  - Society had become rigid and hereditary; salvation seemed impossible without **Brahmin-led** rituals
  - **Vaishyas and Shudras**, treated as lower, found a path in **Jainism and Buddhism**
- Tekwada = an **Iron Age** site located in **Maharashtra** (mentioned on this slide)

Q.28 Which of the following texts is considered the earliest Vedic composition depicting the life of early Vedic people?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 18 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

1. Samaveda
2. Atharvaveda
3. **Rigveda**
4. Yajurveda

- Rigveda was compiled in the Early Vedic period; it describes the life of early Vedic people

- Samaveda, **Yajurveda**, **Atharvaveda** were compiled in the Later **Vedic Age**
  - Samaveda - oldest book on music
  - Yajurveda - prayers and rituals
  - Atharvaveda - magical spells and charms

Q.29 The Rigveda, the oldest of the Vedas, mainly consists of which of the following?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 18 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

1. Ritual manuals
2. Epic narratives
3. Philosophical essays
4. **Hymns**

- **Rigveda mainly consists of hymns (Suktas)**
  - **1028** hymns, about **10,600** verses
  - Hymns are recited by the **Hotri** priest
  - Ritual manuals belong to the **Yajurveda**

- **Rigveda has 10 Mandalas (10 books)**
  - Mandalas 2 to 7 are the oldest; 1, 8, 9, 10 were added later
  - Important mandalas for the exam: 3, 7, 9, 10
- **3rd Mandala: Gayatri Mantra** - composed by **Vishwamitra**, for **Savitri**
- **7th Mandala: Dasarajna war**
  - Bharata tribe led by Sudas vs a confederacy of 10 kings; **Bharatas** won
  - Fought on the banks of the **Purushni** river (today's **Ravi**)
- **9th Mandala**: about **Soma** (god of plants) and the **Somarasa** drink

- **10th Mandala: Purusha Sukta** - origin of the four varnas from a cosmic being (**Cosmic God / Brahma**)
  - Brahmins - from the mouth
  - Kshatriyas - from the arms
  - Vaishyas - from the thighs
  - Shudras - from the feet
- **Deities in the Rigveda**
  - Indra - also called **Purandar** (destroyer of forts)
  - Agni - god of fire; carries offerings to the gods
  - Varuna - god of **Rita** (cosmic order)
  - Aditi - mother of all gods
  - Usha - goddess of dawn

Q.30 Which of the following Vedas is known as the 'Veda of Music'?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 17 Jun, 2026 (4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)]

1. **Samaveda**
2. Atharvaveda
3. Rigveda
4. Yajurveda

- Samaveda = **Veda of Music**; the oldest book on music

Q.31 Which human species is associated with the Upper Paleolithic cultural phase?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 16 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

1. Homo erectus populations moving out of Africa
2. Homo neanderthalensis in European and Asian regions
3. **Anatomically Modern Homo sapiens across the Old World**
4. Denisovan groups settled in mountain environments

- Homo erectus skull in **India** was found at **Hathnora**

- **Upper Palaeolithic** is linked with modern **Homo** sapiens

Q.32 The 'Mesolithic Age' is regarded as a transitional phase because it represents the shift between which two prehistoric periods?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 16 Jun, 2026 (12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)]

1. Neolithic Age and Chalcolithic Age
2. Bronze Age and Iron Age
3. **Palaeolithic Age and Neolithic Age**
4. Chalcolithic Age and Iron Age

- Palaeo = old, **Meso** = middle, **Neo** = new -> **Mesolithic** lies between **Palaeolithic and Neolithic**
- Mesolithic is linked with microliths
- Mesolithic people were hunters and herders (they hunted and also kept some animals); **Palaeolithic** people were hunters and gatherers

- **Other options are wrong**
  - Chalcolithic ran parallel to the **Indus Valley** (Late Harappan) phase
  - **Bronze Age** = Harappan; **Iron Age** = Later Vedic
- Rough time spans (sources differ; remember only the approximate range)
  - Palaeolithic: up to about **10,000 BC** (some sources **12,000 BC**)
  - Mesolithic: about 10,000 - 7,000/**8,000 BC**
  - Neolithic: about **7000 - 1000 BC**
- **Palaeolithic has three sub-phases**: Lower (Early), **Middle, Upper** - in this order
  - Lower (Early) **Palaeolithic** (also called **Acheulian**): roughly 5,00,000 - **50,000 BC**
  - **Middle Palaeolithic**: roughly 50,000 - **40,000 BC**
  - **Upper Palaeolithic**: roughly 40,000 - **10,000 BC**

Q.33 Microlithic tools became a characteristic feature during which phase of prehistory in India?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 15 Jun, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

1. Early Iron Age
2. Lower Palaeolithic
3. Middle Palaeolithic
4. **Mesolithic**

- Microlithic tools are the hallmark of the **Mesolithic age**
- Microlith = small stone tool

Q.34 The earliest evidence of stone tools in India has been found at:

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 15 Jun, 2026 (4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)]

1. Mehrgarh (Mehrgarh)
2. Lothal (Lothal)
3. Hunsgi Valley (Hunsgi Valley)
4. **Attirampakkam (Attirampakkam)**

- Attirampakkam (**Tamil Nadu**) gave the earliest evidence of stone tools in **India** – mainly **Acheulian** tools
- Animal footprints were also found here
- Note: Teacher initially mentioned **Attirampakkam** as a **Middle Palaeolithic** site, and later clarified during the doubt session at the end of the lecture that both **Hunsgi and Attirampakkam** are **Lower Palaeolithic sites**, with **Attirampakkam** yielding the earliest **Acheulian** stone tools
- Other options
  - Mehrgarh = oldest **Neolithic** site (**Pakistan**)
  - Lothal = **Indus Valley** site
  - **Hunsgi Valley** (**Karnataka**) = **Lower Palaeolithic** site

- **Lower Palaeolithic sites and their regions**
  - **Soan Valley – Punjab**
  - **Belan Valley** – around **Mirzapur, Uttar Pradesh**
  - Didwana – **Rajasthan** (also has **Upper Palaeolithic** levels)
  - Hunsgi – **Karnataka**
  - Pahalgam – **Jammu and Kashmir**
  - Kurnool – ash evidence (teacher mentioned it under **Karnataka**)
  - Patne (**Maharashtra**) – ostrich eggshell evidence
- Many sites show more than one **Stone Age** level

Q.35 Which of the following sites has yielded Acheulian, Middle and Upper Palaeolithic and Mesolithic levels?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 14 Jun, 2026 (12:45 PM – 2:15 PM)]

1. Chirki-Nevasa in Maharashtra
2. Adamgarh in Madhya Pradesh
3. **Bhimbetka Rock Shelters in Madya Pradesh**
4. Paisra in Munger district, Bihar

- Adamgarh (**MP**) – mainly a **Mesolithic** site
  - Evidence of domestication of animals
  - Bagor (**Rajasthan**) also gave evidence of animal domestication
  - Animal domestication began in the **Mesolithic** age – hence the people are called hunters and herders

- Bhimbetka is in **Madhya Pradesh**, about **40 km** south-east of **Bhopal**
- Discovered in **1957** by **V.S. Wakankar** while travelling from **Bhopal** to **Itarsi**
- Every **Stone Age** level is found here: Old, **Middle and New Stone Age**

Q.36 The early Iron Age in North India is most prominently associated with which pottery culture?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 14 Jun, 2026 (12:45 PM – 2:15 PM)]

1. **Painted Grey Ware and Northern Black Polished Ware**
2. Painted Grey Ware and Black-and-Red Ware
3. Ochre Coloured Pottery and Black Slipped Ware
4. Northern Black Polished Ware and Red Ware

- Iron was discovered in the Later Vedic age, which is linked with **Painted Grey Ware (PGW)**
- NBPW belongs to the **Mahajanapada** period; iron was known then too
- So the iron-using pottery cultures are **PGW and NBPW**
- Other combinations are wrong because they include the pottery of the earlier non-iron phases (**BRW, OCP**)

- **Memory tip**: BOPN (read as "**Balance of Payment N**") – in chronological order
  - B = **Black-and-Red Ware (BRW)** – Indus Valley phase (as taught)
  - O = **Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)** – Early Vedic phase (as taught)
  - P = **Painted Grey Ware (PGW)** – Later Vedic
  - N = **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** – Mahajanapada period
- Order in history: **Indus Valley** -> Early Vedic -> Later Vedic -> **Mahajanapada**

Q.37 The Rigveda mentions the terms arya varna and dasa varna. In the Early Vedic context, these terms indicate:

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 09 May, 2026 (4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)]

1. **Distinction between Vedic people and non-Vedic groups**
2. Occupational guilds based on trade specialization
3. Fourf old caste hierarchy based strictly on birth
4. Political offices within tribal administration

- Arya = Vedic people
- Dasa / **Dasyu** = non-Vedic people, believed to be the original inhabitants
- Fourfold varna based strictly on birth came only in the Later Vedic age

- **Aryan theory**
  - **North Indians** are said to have come from **Central Asia**
  - **South Indians (Dravidians)** consider themselves the original inhabitants, with differences of colour and language

Q.38 Which of the following sites contains prehistoric paintings ranging from the Mesolithic to the historic period?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 07 May, 2026 (9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)]

1. Hampi
2. Nalanda
3. Pattadakal
4. **Bhimbetka**

- Bhimbetka rock shelters have paintings from the **Mesolithic** period to the historic period

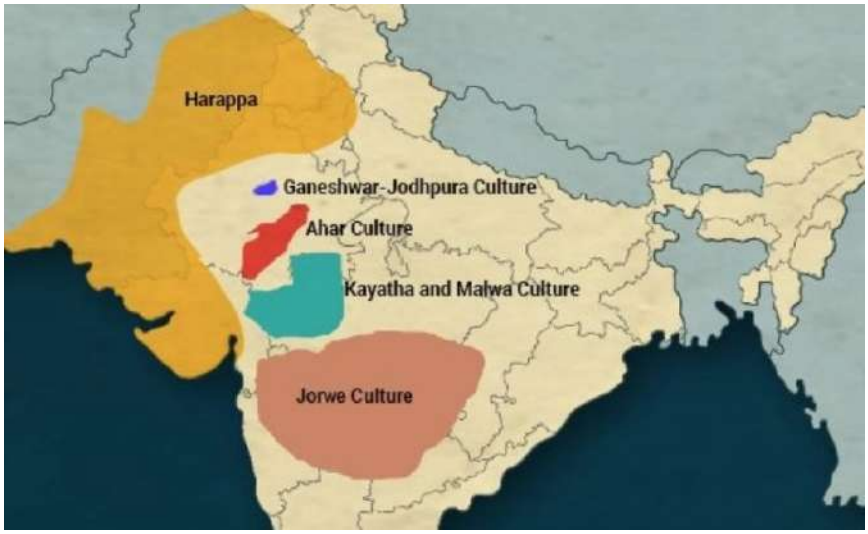
Q.39 Which of the following was NOT an excavated site of the Banas culture?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 22 Mar, 2026 Shift 2]

1. Gilund
2. Ahar
3. Bagor
4. **Nagda**

- Banas (**Ahar-Banas**) culture is a **Chalcolithic** culture of **Rajasthan**
- Gilund, **Ahar and Bagor** are **Rajasthan** sites
- Nagda is in **Madhya Pradesh** (near the **Chambal** valley), in the **Malwa** culture

- **Chalcolithic cultures by region**
  - Rajasthan: Ahar-Banas, **Gilund, Ganeshwar-Jodhpura**
  - **Madhya Pradesh**: Kayatha, **Malwa**, and Eran
  - Maharashtra: Jorwe (**Jorwe** was the first site; **Daimabad** the largest)



Q.40 The archaeological site of Langhnaj in Gujarat, known for microlithic tools and evidence of hunting-gathering communities, is associated with which prehistoric cultural phase?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 18 Mar, 2026 Shift 2]

1. Chalcolithic culture
2. Palaeolithic culture
3. **Mesolithic culture**
4. Neolithic culture

- Hint in the question itself: microlithic tools = **Mesolithic**
- Langhnaj is a **Mesolithic** site in **Gujarat**

Q.41 Which of the following was a function of the Vaishya class in later Vedic society?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 18 Mar, 2026 Shift 2]

1. Subordinated class
2. Ruling class
3. Ritual specialists
4. **Producing class**

- **Functions of the four varnas in Later Vedic society**
  - Brahmins – performed rituals
  - Kshatriyas – ruling class
  - Vaishyas – producing class (production, trade, business)
  - Shudras – subordinate class

- Sabha – assembly of learned **Brahmins**
- Samiti – assembly of common people
- Women could take part in both in the Early Vedic period; in the Later Vedic period their position worsened and their participation was removed

Q.42 Akhaj Mesolithic site is found in which state of India?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 19 Mar, 2026 Shift 2]

1. Assam
2. Meghalaya
3. **Gujarat**
4. Bihar

- **Akhaj Mesolithic** site is in **Mehsana** district, **Gujarat**

Q.43 Which Vedic text, composed around 1000 BCE, contains 1028 hymns dedicated to various deities?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 17 Mar, 2026 Shift 3]

1. Yajur Veda
2. **Rig Veda**
3. Atharva Veda
4. Sama Veda

- **Rig Veda** has **1028 hymns**, recited by the **Hotri**

Q.44 Which of the following technological advances enabled the cultivation of heavier, wetter soils in the early Iron Age?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 17 Mar, 2026 Shift 2]

1. **Iron ploughshares and axes**
2. Copper sickles and knives
3. Stone microliths and scrapers
4. Bronze chisels and spades

- **Iron was discovered in the Later Vedic age**
  - **Harappans and Early Vedic** people did not know iron
- Iron ploughshares and axes made farming of heavy soils possible, so Later Vedic people took up agriculture

- **Vedic names of grains**
  - Wheat – **Godhuma**
  - Rice – **Vrihi**
  - Barley – **Yava**

Q.45 Which technique was primarily used to produce flake tools in India during the Middle Palaeolithic culture?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 25 Mar, 2026 Shift 2]

1. Percussion method
2. Blade-tool technology
3. **Levallois technique**
4. Pressure flaking

- **Middle Palaeolithic tools** = flake tools, made by the **Levallois** technique
- Flakes were struck off by hitting stones together, leaving sharp edges that could be used for many jobs

- **Tools of each age**
  - **Lower Palaeolithic:** cleavers and hand-axes
  - **Middle Palaeolithic:** flake tools (Levallois)
  - **Upper Palaeolithic:** blade technology - blades and burins
  - Mesolithic: microliths

Q.46 Bhimbetka Paleolithic site is located near which river valley of India?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 25 Mar, 2026 Shift 1]

1. Yamuna
2. **Narmada**
3. Ganga
4. Satluj

- Bhimbetka is in **Madhya Pradesh**, and the river of **MP** in the options is the **Narmada**

Q.47 What did the term 'gopati' refer to in Early Vedic society?

[NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26 • 25 Mar, 2026 Shift 1]

1. **Chief who protects cows**
2. Priest who conducts rituals
3. Warrior who leads battles
4. Head of the family

- Go = cow; **Gopati** = chief who protects cows
- Cow was a measure of wealth in the Early Vedic age

- **Other Early Vedic terms**
  - **Grihapati** - head of the family
  - **Rajan** - warrior (king)
  - **Gomat** - wealthy person (who owned many cows)
  - **Duhitri** - one who milked cows (daughter)
  - **Gavishti** - war for cows

Q.48 The Bhimbetka rock shelters are associated with which prehistoric period?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 08 Sept, 2025 Shift 3]

1. Upper Neolithic
2. **Lower Paleolithic**
3. Iron Age
4. Lower Chalcolithic

- Bhimbetka is a Stone Age site.
- Earliest evidence of human activity dates to the Lower Palaeolithic Age.
- "Upper Neolithic" is not the correct answer.
- Bhimbetka has evidence from three Palaeolithic phases: Lower, Middle and Upper.

Q.49 Which of the following best describes the authorship of the Rigveda?

[NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26 • 16 Jun, 2026 (12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)]

1. Composed solely by Sage Vyasa and compiled during the Mahabharata era
2. Dictated by Valmiki as a poetic epic for oral transmission
3. Written by a single philosopher-king in ancient India
4. **Collection of hymns composed by various sages over generations**

- Rigveda is a collection of hymns (**1028**, known as **Suktas**), composed by various sages over a long period

Q.50 The rock shelters of Bhimbetka are located in which of the following states of India?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 08 Sept, 2025 Shift 2]

1. **Madhya Pradesh**
2. Haryana
3. Bihar
4. Odisha

- Bhimbetka rock shelters are in **Madhya Pradesh**, near **Bhopal**

Q.51 The indigenous inhabitants of India who were hostile, dark skinned and did not follow the Vedic system are referred to in Vedic texts as:

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 04 Sept, 2025 Shift 3]

1. **Dasyus**
2. Dasas
3. Dravidas
4. Aryans

- **Dasyus** = hostile, dark-skinned, non-Vedic original inhabitants
- Dasas are also mentioned in the **Rigveda** – people who worked under the **Aryans**; they were mostly the same Dasyus who had been subdued
- If both Dasyu and Dasa are options, choose Dasyu for the "hostile" people

- Because of the **Aryan-Dravidian** debate and the undeciphered **Indus Valley** script (**Proto-historic** period), the **Tamil Nadu** government (under **M.K. Stalin**) announced a **$1 million (~₹9 crore)** reward for anyone who deciphers the Harappan script

Q.52 Social life in the Vedic period was divided into how many ashramas?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 04 Sept, 2025 Shift 2]

1. **Four**
2. Three
3. Six
4. Ten

- **Four ashramas (stages of life)**
  - **Brahmacharya** – education; till age 25
  - **Grihastha** – householder; age 25 – 50
  - **Vanaprastha** – going to the forest
  - **Sanyasa** – renunciation
- Mentioned in the **Jabala Upanishad**, part of the **Shukla Yajurveda**

- Yajurveda has two parts: **Shukla** (white / pure) and **Krishna** (black / mixed)
- **Katha Upanishad**: dialogue between **Yama and Nachiketa**
- **Satyameva Jayate** is from the **Mundaka Upanishad**

Q.53 The Lower Palaeolithic period in India, including the Acheulian phase, spans approximately how many years BP?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 04 Sept, 2025 Shift 1]

1. **6,00,000–1,50,000 years BP**
2. 1,65,000–31,000 years BP
3. 1,00,000–10,000 years BP
4. 40,000–12,000 years

- BP = Before Present (not BC)
- **Lower Palaeolithic** = **Acheulian** phase = **6,00,000 – 1,50,000 BP**
- The other ranges start late or run into the **Middle** and **Upper Palaeolithic**, so only the first fits the **Lower Palaeolithic**
  - 1,65,000 – 31,000 years BP -> **Middle Palaeolithic**
  - 40,000 – 12,000 years BP -> **Upper Palaeolithic**
- Acheulian = named for the type of stone tools used (large stones, hand-axes)

Q.54 Bori, which is considered to be the first Lower Palaeolithic site, is in which of the following states of India?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 03 Sept, 2025 Shift 3]

1. Gujarat
2. Arunachal Pradesh
3. Tamil Nadu
4. **Maharashtra**

- Bori (**Maharashtra**) = first **Lower Palaeolithic** site

Q.55 Which of the four Vedas is traditionally paired with the Upaveda known as Gandharvaveda?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 03 Sept, 2025 Shift 3]

1. Yajurveda
2. Atharvaveda
3. **Samaveda**
4. Rigveda

- Other Upavedas
  - **Ayurveda** – medicine and health
  - **Shilpaveda** (also called Sthapatya Veda) – **architecture, art and craft**

- **Gandharvaveda** = music; paired with the **Samaveda** (Veda of Music)

Q.56 Which archaeological site shows pit dwellings and evidence of domesticated dogs during the Neolithic period?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 01 Sept, 2025 Shift 1]

1. Chirand
2. **Burzahom**
3. Koldihwa
4. Hallur

- **Burzahom** – in Jammu and Kashmir
  - Name means "**place of birch**"
  - People lived in pit dwellings (dug pits and lived inside)
  - Evidence of domestication of dogs
- Gufkral ("cave of potters") – also in **Jammu and Kashmir**; same features

- Mehrgarh (**Pakistan**) – people lived in houses with walls; oldest Neolithic site of the Indian subcontinent
- Chirand – near **Patna**; bone tools found
- Koldihwa – **Uttar Pradesh**
- Hallur – **Karnataka**
- Sangna – **Karnataka**
- **Neolithic (New Stone Age) features**
  - Agriculture began; people started owning property
  - Use of polished stone tools (teacher said "painted stones")
  - Pottery to store grain; cord-impressed pottery (pots with a cord pattern like embroidery)

Q.57 Which of the following groups of people is said to have migrated into the late Indus Valley era India from Central Asia?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 29 Aug, 2025 Shift 1]

1. Dravidas
2. Mesopotamians
3. **Aryans**
4. Shakas

- Aryans are said to have migrated from **Central Asia** into **India**

Q.58 During the Later Vedic period, which of the following animals was specifically mentioned as useful for ploughing swampy land?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 28 Aug, 2025 Shift 2]

1. Cow
2. **Buffalo**
3. Horse
4. Elephant

- In the **Later Vedic** period the buffalo was used to plough swampy land
- Cow lost some of its importance in the Later Vedic age (it was still present, but less than in the Early Vedic age)

Q.59 Which of the following was NOT a reason for the Paleolithic people to move from place to place?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 22 Aug, 2025 Shift 1]

1. **Failure of crops**
2. Resource exhaustion
3. Movement of prey animals
4. Seasonal changes

- Palaeolithic people did not grow crops; agriculture began in the **Neolithic** age
- They moved because of shortage of resources, movement of prey animals (which they hunted) and seasonal changes

- Palaeolithic people discovered fire - striking two stones together produced fire

Q.60 What is the main content of the four Vedas composed during the Early Vedic period?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 18 Aug, 2025 Shift 1]

1. War strategies
2. Agricultural manuals
3. Laws and rituals
4. **Prayers and hymns**

- Early Vedic period -> mainly **Rigveda**; content = prayers and hymns (**Samhita** = collection of hymns)
- Teacher first misread and said "laws and rituals", then corrected it to prayers and hymns

- **Subdivisions of the Vedas**
  - Samhita - collection of hymns
  - Brahmana - sacrifices and rituals (earlier placed at the end of the **Vedas** before **Upanishads** were added)
  - Aranyaka - for hermits living in forests; practices they must follow
  - Upanishads - added later at the end of the **Vedas**; called **Vedanta** (examples: **Jabala, Katha, Mundaka**)

- Vedangas - 6 auxiliary aids to understand the **Vedas**
  - **Shiksha** - phonetics
  - **Vyakarana** - grammar
  - **Jyotisha** - astronomy (teacher said "study of light")
  - **Kalpa** - rituals / practices to be performed
  - **Nirukta** - etymology (study of words)
  - **Chhanda** - poetic metre

Q.61 The Acheulian cultural tradition is primarily identified with which types of advanced and symmetrical stone tools?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 14 Aug, 2025 Shift 1]

1. Blades and borers
2. Microliths and scrapers
3. Chisels and adzes
4. **Cleavers and hand-axes**

- **Acheulian** = Lower Palaeolithic; tools = cleavers and hand-axes (big stones)

- Elimination
  - Blades and borers -> **Upper Palaeolithic**
  - Microliths -> **Mesolithic**
  - Chisels and adzes -> flake technology of the **Middle Palaeolithic**

Q.62 The term gomat in the Rigveda refers to which of the following?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 14 Aug, 2025 Shift 2]

1. A warrior
2. A priest
3. **A wealthy person**
4. A milkmaid

- **Gomat** = wealthy person who owned many cows
- Cow was a symbol of wealth in the Early Vedic age

Q.63 Microliths, which are tiny stone tools usually stuck on to handles of bones or woods to make tools like saws and sickles. These were mostly found in which age?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 13 Aug, 2025 Shift 2]

1. Paleolithic age
2. Chalcolithic age
3. **Mesolithic age**
4. Neolithic age

- **Microliths** = tiny stone tools fixed on handles of bone or wood to make saws and sickles
- Found mostly in the Mesolithic age

Q.64 Which of the following Vedic words literally means search for cows and also refers to battle?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 13 Aug, 2025 Shift 1]

1. Duhitri
2. **Gaveshana**
3. Gopala
4. Gomat

- The word that literally means "search for cows" and also battle is **Gavishti** (war for cows)
- Gavishti is not given in the options, so by elimination **Gaveshana** is the answer

- Other options
  - **Gomat** - wealthy person
  - **Duhitri** - one who milked the cows
  - **Gopala** - cowherd / protector of cows

Q.65 Which of the following Vedas mentions the names of some learned ladies like Viswavara, Apala and Ghosa who composed mantras and attained the rank of Rishis?

[RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024 • 11 Aug, 2025 Shift 3]

1. **The Rigveda**
2. The Samaveda
3. The Yajurveda
4. The Atharvaveda

- Rigveda mentions learned women **Vishvavara, Apala, Ghosha,** who composed hymns and became **Rishis**
- Rigveda mentions goddesses too (**Aditi, Usha**), not only male gods (such as **Indra / Purandar** - destroyer of forts, **Agni** - god of fire who carries havan offerings to the gods, **Soma** - lord of plants in the 9th Mandala, and Varuna - god of Rita)

Q.66 Which of the following caves contain rock cut paintings dating back to the stone age era?

[RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 • 23 Jun, 2025 Shift 1]

1. Barabar caves
2. **Bhimbetka caves**
3. Ajanta caves
4. Ellora caves

- Bhimbetka caves have **Stone Age** rock paintings
- Barabar (**Mauryan** period), **Ajanta** and **Ellora** belong to later (historic) periods - covered later in the course

Q.67 The evidence of the earliest cotton cultivation in the Indus valley is found at which site?

[RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 • 14 Jun, 2025 Shift 2]

1. Harappa
2. Kalibangan
3. **Mehrgarh**
4. Rakhigarhi

- Mehrgarh gave the earliest evidence of cotton cultivation
- Mehrgarh is the oldest **Neolithic** site of the subcontinent, in **Pakistan** (people at **Mehrgarh** lived in walled houses, whereas at **Neolithic** sites **Burzahom and Gufkral** in J&K people lived in pit dwellings)

Q.68 Which of the following is NOT one of the primary tones used in Vedic chanting?

[RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024 • 12 Jun, 2025 Shift 1]

1. Svarita
2. **Mandrata**
3. Anudaatta
4. Udatta

- **Three primary tones in Vedic chanting**
  - **Udatta** – high tone
  - **Anudatta** – low tone
  - **Svarita** – mixed / combined tone
- Mandrata is not a Vedic tone



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